

HIGH

Sextortion

Alert ID: ALERT-SE | Generated: 2024-06-14 09:00:00 UTC

Routed to: Compliance Team · Fraud Risk Team · Tm Analytics Team

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A HIGH-priority Sextortion threat is targeting UOB's male retail customers aged 18–35 across Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand, and Indonesia. Approximately 67,200 customers are at risk with no existing TM rule coverage — 88% of attacks would currently go undetected. Baseline financial exposure is estimated at SGD 8.9M (P50), with a worst case of SGD 22M. Immediate action: issue targeted customer advisory within 24 hours and deploy urgency-pattern TM detection rule.

THREAT INTELLIGENCE BRIEF

Sextortion attacks are orchestrated by criminal networks primarily based in West Africa and the Philippines. The attack sequence: (1) Fraudster creates fake female profile on social media → (2) Targets male users aged 18-35 → (3) Builds rapport and solicits explicit images/videos → (4) Immediately pivots to extortion: 'pay or I send to your family/employer' → (5) Victim makes urgent bank transfer or purchases gift cards under duress. The FBI IC3 reported 12,000+ victims and USD 15M+ in losses globally in 2023. Singapore and Southeast Asia are now primary growth markets for this fraud, driven by high smartphone penetration and high-value banking customers in the 18-35 age group.

UOB RELEVANCE ASSESSMENT

Gate	Result	Details
Gate 1 — Novelty	✓ PASSED	No existing TM rule covers sextortion typology; moderate-high novelty as pattern is emerging in ASEAN region
Gate 2 — Customer Exposure	✓ PASSED	✓ RETAIL customers (male 18-35) in SG/TH/ID; ~67,200 at risk
Gate 3 — Control Gap	✓ PASSED	✓ 88% of attacks undetected (no TM rules cover sextortion); SMS OTP auth vulnerability: YES

Composite Risk Score: 76/100 — HIGH Priority

No UOB TM rule currently targets the sextortion pattern. The 88% undetected rate is the highest control gap of any current threat in the alert queue. UOB's retail customer base includes approximately 67,200 male customers aged 18-35 using mobile banking — exactly the demographic targeted by this campaign. Composite risk score: 76.5/100 (HIGH).

FINANCIAL IMPACT SIMULATION

Scenario	Exposure (SGD)
Baseline (no intervention)	SGD 10.1M
With current TM controls	SGD 8.5M

With proposed interventions	SGD 3.2M
P10 (optimistic)	SGD 3.2M
P50 (median)	SGD 8.9M
P90 (worst case)	SGD 22.0M

Baseline exposure: SGD 10.1M. With current controls: SGD 8.5M (gift card rule provides ~16% coverage). With proposed interventions: SGD 3.2M. P10: SGD 3.2M, P50: SGD 8.9M, P90: SGD 22.0M.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

■ Immediate (<24 hours)

- Issue targeted push notification to 67,200 male retail customers aged 18-35 warning of sextortion campaigns
- Activate manual review for all first-time overseas transfers > SGD 200 by customers aged 18-35
- Brief call centre staff on sextortion victim support protocol

■ Short-term (1–7 days)

- Submit urgency-pattern TM detection rule: first overseas transfer + young male + night hours
- Implement welfare check pop-up for first-time overseas transfers (18-35 demographic)
- Coordinate with DBS/OCBC/HSBC for industry-wide alert under MAS Fraud Watch framework
- Update SCB SafeGuard app integration with sextortion warning category

■ Strategic (1–4 weeks)

- Develop formal Sextortion Victim Support Protocol with SPF and Samaritans of Singapore referral pathway
- Commission study on social media platform collaboration for fraudulent profile takedown

PROPOSED INTERVENTION RULES

1. **TM_DETECTION** Risk: MEDIUM · Impact: ~28% · Auto-deployable: No

Detect sextortion payment pattern: sudden first-time overseas transfer or multiple gift card purchases following social media account activity on registered device.

```
IF customer has NO prior overseas_transfer_history AND overseas_transfer > SGD 200 AND
customer_age_band IN [18-25, 26-35] AND time_of_day IN [evening/night] THEN flag
SEXTORTION_RISK
```

■ Requires Head of Fraud Risk sign-off

2. **CUSTOMER_FRICTION** Risk: MEDIUM · Impact: ~22% · Auto-deployable: No

Implement welfare check pop-up for first-time overseas transfers by customers in the 18-35 demographic, displaying sextortion warning and SafeGuard hotline.

```
IF first_overseas_transfer = TRUE AND customer_age IN [18,35] THEN display welfare_check_modal
with sextortion_advisory + scam_helpline before processing
```

■ Requires Head of Fraud Risk sign-off

3. **POLICY_CHANGE** Risk: LOW · Impact: ~15% · Auto-deployable: No

Establish dedicated Sextortion Victim Support Protocol with fast-track transaction reversal process and referral to Police/Samaritans of Singapore.

IF customer reports sextortion_coercion to call_centre THEN activate fast_track_reversal_protocol AND provide SPF_report_guidance AND SOS_referral

■ Requires Head of Fraud Risk sign-off

4. **ADVISORY** Risk: LOW · Impact: ~15% · Auto-deployable: Yes

Issue targeted advisory to male retail customers aged 18-35 warning of sextortion tactics, with guidance to not make any payments and to report to SPF.

IF customer_segment = RETAIL AND gender_indicator = MALE AND age IN [18,35] THEN send targeted_advisory via push + email WITHIN 24h

EVIDENCE SOURCES

- 1. FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3) — Sextortion Alert 2024
- 2. Singapore Police Force — Cybercrimes statistics 2023
- 3. Interpol — Financial Sextortion Threat Assessment ASEAN 2024

ANALYST NOTES & CAVEATS

This alert is AI-generated. It must be reviewed by a qualified fraud risk analyst before operational action is taken. Age/gender segmentation is derived from synthetic persona dataset and may not reflect actual customer distribution. Victim conversion rate assumption (100%) is based on FBI IC3 case study data and may vary by geography. Recommended validation: cross-reference with recent fraud operations case files for sextortion reports.